

CAUSATIVE & PERMISSION VERBS

QUEM MANDA **AQUI?**

Who's in charge here?

Five ways to talk about control in English: forcing, persuading, permitting and authorizing. Same idea, five different grammars, five different relationships of power.

WHY THIS LESSON MATTERS

*Tal coisa te deixa louco. Tal pessoa te deixa nervoso. Em português, **deixar** faz dois trabalhos ao mesmo tempo: permissão e causa.*

In English, they're two different verbs. Your instinct will often reach for **LET**, because that's what "deixar" means most of the time. But a feeling someone causes in you is **MAKE**, not LET. "It lets me crazy" doesn't exist. "It makes me crazy" does.

BEFORE WE START

At home

At work

With kids

Growing up

- Does anyone at home ever make you do chores you don't feel like doing?
- What do you let your partner or roommate get away with?
- Is there anything your family allows during holidays that they don't allow the rest of the year?

01 MAKE SOMEONE/SOMETHING + ADJECTIVE

MAKE + person/thing + ADJECTIVE (or comparative)

Not an action. A feeling or a state that something causes, in a person or in a situation. The adjective can also level up into a comparative: "it makes things worse", not just "it makes things bad".

FORCE  PERMISSION

Sunday afternoon at the Miller house. Nobody is really in charge, but everyone in that room is feeling something, and something outside of them is causing it.



1. make her focused

The homework makes her focused, but the draw **1** makes her happier.

2. make him relaxed

Video games after a long **4** week make him relaxed.

3. make him hungry

Chopping vegetables next to the stove makes him hungry.

4. make her calm

The dog sleeping at her feet makes her calm.

PUSH IT FURTHER: EXTREME ADJECTIVES

Extreme adjectives already mean "very ___", so they don't take "very" itself. Use **absolutely**, **completely** or **utterly** instead.

tired →

exhausted

exausto(a)

hungry →

starving

faminto(a), morrendo de fome

angry →

furious

furioso(a)

scared →

terrified

apavorado(a)

happy →

thrilled

radiante, muito animado(a)

surprised →

astonished

pasmo(a), estupefato(a)

interesting →

fascinating

fascinante

bad →

awful

péssimo(a), horrível

Not "very furious". **Absolutely furious.**

SAME FEELING, ANOTHER VERB

The traffic makes me furious.

Something outside causes it.

I get furious when I'm stuck in traffic.

You change state yourself. No object, no person in the middle.

This GET means **become**. It's a different job from the GET in Case 03, which means persuade. Same word, two grammars, don't mix them up.

NUMBERED IN THE PHOTO, THEN BORROW THESE

make someone **happy**

make someone **nervous**

make someone **proud**

make someone **uncomfortable**

make someone **bored**

make someone **frustrated**

WITH THINGS, AND WITH COMPARATIVES

make it **worse**

make it **better**

make it **harder**

make it **easier**

make things **complicated**

REAL TALK

Sem verbo de ação depois do objeto, só adjetivo. E esse objeto não precisa ser gente: "it", "things", "the situation" entram no mesmo lugar. O adjetivo também pode virar comparativo, "makes it worse" é tão comum quanto "makes me happy".

COMPLETE THE ONE THAT FITS YOUR LIFE

Long meetings that go nowhere make me *adjective* _____

Being stuck in traffic every morning makes me *adjective* _____

A compliment from my boss makes me *adjective* _____

Skipping breakfast always makes my whole morning *comparative* _____

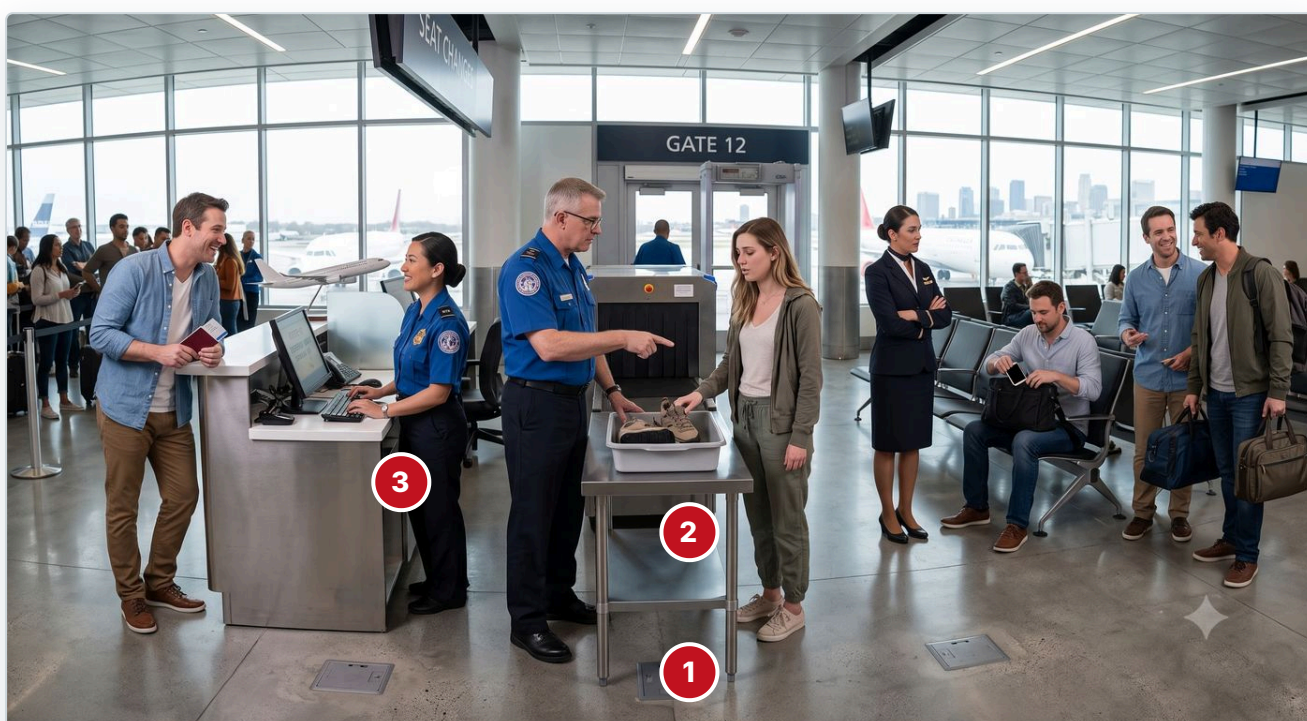
02 MAKE SOMEONE DO

MAKE + person + **BASE VERB**

An action, and no choice about it. Someone with authority forces it.

FORCE  PERMISSION

Gate 12. The line moves, the officer points, and nobody argues. This is what obligation looks like when it has a uniform.



1. make her take off her shoes

Security makes every passenger take off their shoes before the scanner.

2. make passengers empty their pockets

The machine makes travelers empty their pockets first.

3. make him show his passport

The agent makes him show his passport before printing the boarding pass.

NUMBERED IN THE PHOTO, THEN BORROW THESE

make someone **wait**

make someone **remove**

make someone **sign**

make someone **repeat**

make someone **show ID**

REAL TALK

Sem "to": "make her take off", nunca "make her to take off". Igual ao LET. O difícil aqui não é a gramática, é lembrar que não tem escolha.

COMPLETE THE ONE THAT FITS YOUR LIFE

My manager always makes me *base verb* _____ before I leave the office.

Airport security makes every passenger *base verb* _____ before boarding.

My landlord makes tenants *base verb* _____ before moving out.

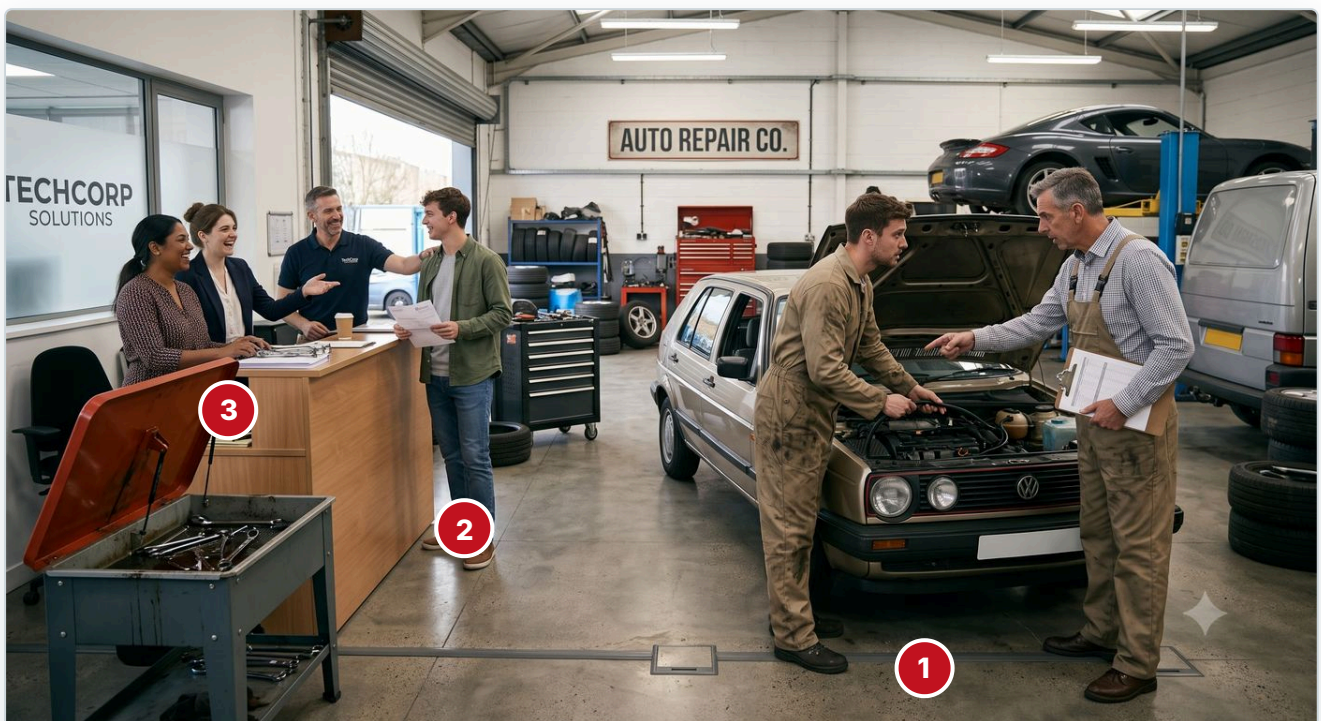
03 GET SOMEONE TO DO

GET + person + TO + VERB

Persuasion. There is a choice, but you work to influence it.

FORCE  PERMISSION

The customer wasn't planning to spend that much today. Twenty minutes later, he's nodding at the estimate. Nobody forced him. Somebody just explained it well.



1. get him to approve the repair

The mechanic gets him to approve the repair by explaining exactly what's broken.

2. get her to sign the estimate

The receptionist gets her to sign the estimate before the work starts.

3. get him to trust the shop

Years of honest work get customers to trust the shop.

NUMBERED IN THE PHOTO, THEN BORROW THESE

get someone to **agree**

get someone to **understand**

get someone to **reconsider**

get someone to **calm down**

get someone to **commit**

REAL TALK

GET traz o "to" de volta, e muda o sentido: alguém foi convencido, não obrigado. "I got him to do it" soa bem mais diplomático que "I made him do it".

COMPLETE THE ONE THAT FITS YOUR LIFE

It took me a week, but I finally got my landlord to *verb* _____ the leak.

She got her coworkers to *verb* _____ the new software without complaining.

I got the mechanic to *verb* _____ me a better price.

04 LET SOMEONE DO

LET + person + **BASE VERB**

Permission, informal. You don't stop it. You simply say yes.

FORCE  PERMISSION

Saturday, the park is full, and for once nobody is in a hurry. Today the answer to almost everything is yes.



1. let her swing higher

Her mother lets her swing higher every time she asks.

2. let them go down the slide

The teacher lets them go down the slide two at a time.

3. let him build a sandcastle

His dad lets him build a sandcastle as tall as he wants.

4. let her buy an ice cream

Her mom finally lets her buy an ice cream from the cart.

NUMBERED IN THE PHOTO, THEN BORROW THESE

let someone **choose**

let someone **stay**

let someone **go first**

let someone **try**

let someone **decide**

REAL TALK

Mesma estrutura de MAKE, sem "to", mas sentido oposto: um força, o outro permite. "Let her go" e "make her go" mudam a história inteira.

COMPLETE THE ONE THAT FITS YOUR LIFE

My boss lets us *base verb* _____ from home on Fridays.

On weekends, I let myself *base verb* _____ until midnight.

Our neighbors let us *base verb* _____ their pool whenever we want.

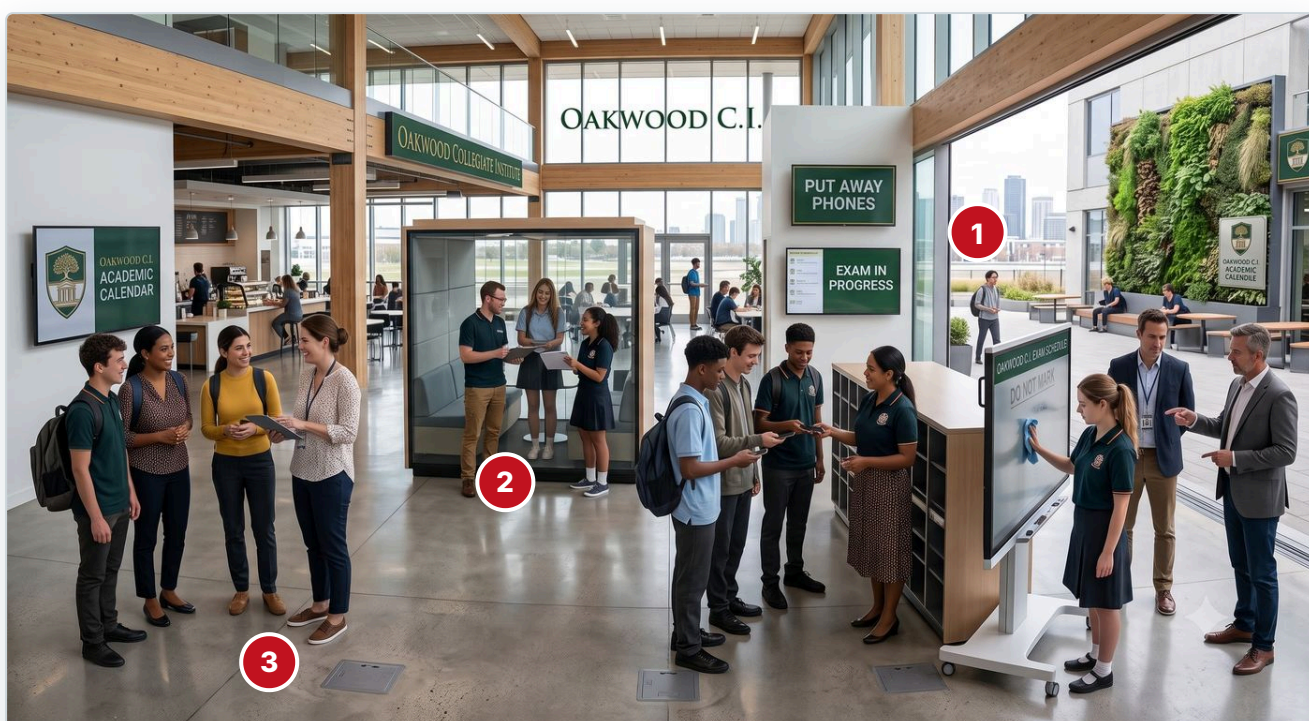
05 ALLOW SOMEONE TO DO

ALLOW + person + TO + VERB

Permission, but official. A rule, a policy, an institution decides.

FORCE  PERMISSION

Oakwood C.I. has a sign for everything. One rule says no. Right next to it, a glass box says yes, quietly, on its own terms.



1. doesn't allow students to use phones

The school doesn't allow students to use their phones during exams.

2. allows students to make private calls

The phone pod allows students to make private calls between classes.

3. allow her to leave early

The coordinator allows her to leave early on Fridays for her internship.

NUMBERED IN THE PHOTO, THEN BORROW THESE

allow someone to **enter**

allow someone to **bring**

not allow someone to **use**

allow someone to **submit late**

allow someone to **reschedule**

REAL TALK

ALLOW é o LET de terno: mesma permissão, mas com "to" e peso institucional. "My mom lets me" é natural. "My mom allows me to" soa quase um contrato.

COMPLETE THE ONE THAT FITS YOUR LIFE

Company policy allows employees to *verb* _____ two days a week from home.

The gym doesn't allow members to *verb* _____ after 10 pm.

My contract allows me to *verb* _____ once a year.

SAME IDEA, FIVE GRAMMARS

Before the quiz, look at all five side by side. This is the map you'll use every time you're not sure which one fits.

STRUCTURE	PATTERN	WHO DECIDES	FEEL
Make + adj	make + person + adjective	the situation, not a person	causes a feeling
Make + do	make + person + base verb	the one with authority	no choice, obligation
	get + person + to + verb	shared, through persuasion	convinced, not forced
Let + do	let + person + base verb	the one who allows	informal permission

STRUCTURE	PATTERN	WHO DECIDES	FEEL
Allow + to do	allow + person + to + verb	a rule or institution	formal permission

QUICK CHECK

1. The dentist always _____ me nervous, even before he says a word.

☐ lets ☐ makes ☐ gets

2. It took the whole meeting, but she finally _____ the team to accept the new schedule.

☐ made ☐ allowed ☐ got

3. Airport rules don't _____ passengers to carry liquids over 100ml.

☐ allow ☐ let ☐ get

4. My grandma always _____ us stay up late during the holidays.

☐ allows ☐ gets ☐ lets

5. The smell of fresh bread from the kitchen _____ everyone hungry.

☐ makes ☐ gets ☐ allows

BONUS CASE

ONE SHOP, FIVE VERBS

Loja de Brinquedos Alegria, Saturday morning. All five structures are happening in the same room at the same time. Tap a pin, then pick the verb

that fits the scene, not just the meaning you'd use in Portuguese.



Each numbered scene below matches a number on the photo. Choose MAKE, GET, LET or ALLOW for each.

The line at the cashier is long. Nobody skips it. The store _____ every customer wait their turn.

makes

lets

gets

allows

The boy in the cape wasn't sure about the Spider-Man toy. His dad _____ him to see how cool the box looked, and now he won't put it down.

made

got

let

allowed

The LEGO table is free to use for anyone. The store _____ kids build whatever they want there, no purchase required.

makes

lets

gets

allows

The girl trying on the jester hat looks thrilled. Trying on hats before buying _____ her excited about the costume section.

makes

lets

gets

allows

Store policy _____ children to test any toy on the shelf before their parents pay for it.

makes

lets

gets

allows

PART 2 · JUDGMENT & TRANSFORMATION

NOW, PROVE IT.

Five verbs, one continuum. In "Quem Manda Aqui" you learned to recognize them. Here you decide, negate, question and flip them, the way you'd actually need to in a real conversation.

BLOCO A

WHAT WOULD YOU DO?

No right answer here. Read the situation, choose a side, then say why. The goal isn't to remember a fact, it's to use the structure to defend a judgment call.

SCENARIO 01

Your employee arrives 40 minutes late, saying the car had a flat tire. It's the third time this month.

Would you ☐ **let it go** or would you ☐ **make him explain in writing**?

WHY? (WRITE IN ENGLISH)

Because...

SCENARIO 02

A colleague refuses to use the new project management tool. She says it's a waste of time, but the rest of the team already switched.

Would you ☐ **get her to try it for a week** or would you ☐ **make her use it starting today?**

WHY? (WRITE IN ENGLISH)

Because...

SCENARIO 03

Your company is deciding on a hybrid work policy. Some managers want everyone back in the office five days a week.

Would you ☐ **allow employees to choose their own schedule** or would you ☐ **make everyone come in the same days?**

WHY? (WRITE IN ENGLISH)

Because...

SCENARIO 04

Your 16-year-old wants to go to a concert on a school night with friends you've never met.

Would you ☐ **let her go** or would you ☐ **only allow it if a parent you know goes too?**

WHY? (WRITE IN ENGLISH)

Because...

SCENARIO 05

A client is unhappy about a delay and is threatening to cancel the contract.

Would you ☐ **get them to agree to a partial refund** or would you
☐ **allow them to cancel with no penalty?**

WHY? (WRITE IN ENGLISH)

Because...

BLOCO B

PURE PRACTICE

Now the mechanics. Upgrade, negate, question, and then the plot twist that changes everything.

B1 • UPGRADE THE SENTENCE

The traffic made him **angry**. → The traffic made him

intensifier + extreme adjective

The news made her **sad**. → The news made her

intensifier + extreme adjective

The final exam made them **scared**. → The final exam made them

intensifier + extreme adjective

The presentation made him **tired**. → The presentation made him

intensifier + extreme adjective

The gift made her **surprised**. → The gift made her

intensifier + extreme adjective

B2 • MAKE IT NEGATIVE

Rainy days **make** me sad. →

negative form

The school **makes** students wear uniforms. →

negative form

She **got** him to apologize. →

negative form

My parents **let** me stay out late. →

negative form

The airline **allows** pets in the cabin. →

negative form

B3 · TURN IT INTO A QUESTION

Rainy days make me sad. →

question form

The school makes students wear uniforms. →

question form

She got him to apologize. →

question form

Your parents let you stay out late. →

question form

The airline allows pets in the cabin. →

question form

NEGATE IT, AND IT JUMPS

Negating these verbs doesn't just soften them. Some flip to the opposite end of the spectrum entirely. Watch where the dot lands.

MAKE, NEGATED

AFFIRMATIVE **My boss makes me** work weekends.



NEGATED **My boss doesn't make me** work weekends.



Removing the obligation doesn't feel neutral, it feels like relief. Negated MAKE slides all the way toward **permission** territory.

LET, NEGATED

AFFIRMATIVE **She lets** her kids stay up late.



NEGATED **She doesn't let** her kids stay up late.



This isn't weak permission, it's a rule. "Doesn't let" means **prohibits**. The dot doesn't slide, it jumps to the other end.

ALLOW, NEGATED

AFFIRMATIVE **The airline allows** pets in the cabin.



NEGATED **The airline doesn't allow** pets in the cabin.



Same jump as LET, only with a policy behind it. "Doesn't allow" is a formal **ban**, not a soft no.

GET, NEGATED (THE EXCEPTION)

AFFIRMATIVE **I got** him to apologize.



NEGATED **I didn't get** him to apologize.



No flip here. It just means the persuasion failed. GET stays in the middle, negated or not, because it was never about power in the first place.

AFFIRMATIVE, NEGATIVE, OR QUESTION?

Six questions, all five structures, no pattern to guess. Read carefully before you choose.

1. "My landlord ___ raise the rent without 60 days' notice." Which fits a legal restriction?

- ☐ gets to ☐ isn't allowed to ☐ makes

2. "___ your parents let you travel alone when you were a teenager?"

- ☐ Do ☐ Did ☐ Does

3. "I get nervous before every presentation." What does this GET mean here?

- ☐ persuade ☐ become ☐ obtain

4. "The dentist's office ___ let me reschedule twice this month." Which negative fits a policy that ran out of patience?

- ☐ won't ☐ doesn't get to ☐ isn't making

5. "It took three meetings, but we finally ___ the board to approve the budget."

- ☐ let ☐ allowed ☐ got

6. "___ the new policy allow remote employees to expense their internet bill?"

- ☐ Does ☐ Is ☐ Did

EDITORIAL READING · CAUSATIVE & PERMISSION VERBS

Two Ways to Raise a Kid

A short piece on helicopter parents and free-range parents, written in the same grammar you studied in "Quem Manda Aqui". Read it once for meaning, then again for the verbs.

BEFORE YOU READ

- Look at the illustrations below. Before reading, guess: which parenting style do you think is more common today?
- Were you raised more like a "helicopter" kid or a "free-range" kid?

At the playground on Saturday morning, you can spot the difference in seconds. One group of parents sits on a bench, phones down, eyes locked on every **wobble** (*balanço, instabilidade*) of the slide. The other group is by the coffee cart, barely glancing over when a kid disappears behind the climbing frame.



Modern parenting rarely looks like a full-time job. It looks like this: working, cooking, and supervising, all at once.

Psychologists have a name for the first group: **helicopter parents**. They **hover** (*pairar, ficar rondando por perto*). They **make** their children wear helmets on tricycles, wash their hands every twenty minutes, and finish every worksheet before dinner. They don't **let** a six-year-old walk to the **corner store** (*mercadinho da esquina*).

alone, and they rarely **allow** a birthday party to happen without a parent standing quietly by the cake table.

The second group has a name too: **free-range parents** (*criação com mais liberdade e menos supervisão*). They **let** their kids climb higher than most adults are comfortable watching. They **allow** eight-year-olds to walk home from school with a set of house keys and a phone. Nobody **makes** these children ask permission to get a snack; the pantry is just there, at kid height, for a reason.

Neither philosophy is new. What changed is the fear behind it. A generation ago, parents worried about traffic and strangers, real but **statistically rare** (*estatisticamente raro*) dangers. Today, many parents worry about something harder to name: the idea that any unsupervised moment might cause lasting harm, socially, academically, emotionally. Watching a child climb too high still **makes** most parents nervous, whichever camp they belong to. Nobody wants to be the one adult at the party who let something happen.



Whatever the philosophy, the instinct to hold on tight starts early.

Free-range advocates argue the opposite fear is just as real. If a child is never **allowed** to fail on their own terms, the theory goes, they arrive at adulthood without ever having solved a real problem alone. A parent who solves every conflict for their kid isn't protecting them, they're just delaying the first real conflict a few years, to a moment when **the stakes** (*o que está em jogo, o risco envolvido*) are higher and the parent isn't in the room.

The difference often shows up in small negotiations, not big rules. A free-range parent might spend ten minutes **getting** a **reluctant** (*relutante, resistente*) four-year-old to put on his own shoes, through **bargaining** (*negociação, barganha*), humor, a countdown, anything but force. A helicopter parent, **running late** (*atrasado(a), sem tempo a perder*) for the same reason, is more likely to just **make** him sit down and put them on herself.



Somewhere between never letting go and letting go too soon, most families find their own line.

Most parents, if you ask them directly, don't fully belong to either camp. They **let** their toddler fall off the low step, but they'd never **let** a ten-year-old take the subway alone. They **make** their teenager text when they arrive somewhere, but **allow** her to choose her own friends without **interrogation** (*interrogatório, terceiro grau*). The line moves, case by case, kid by kid, city by city.

What both camps agree on, oddly, is the goal: a kid who can be trusted to make good decisions once no one is around to make them anymore. They just can't agree on how much **rope** ("*corda*", *aqui: quanta liberdade/autonomia dar*) gets a child there, and how much rope gets a child hurt.

COMPREHENSION CHECK

Answer based on the text. No need for full sentences.

1. True or False: free-range parents let their children walk home from school alone.

True

False

2. According to the text, what changed between generations, if not the parenting philosophy itself?

your answer

3. True or False: the text says free-range parents never negotiate with their kids.

True

False

4. According to free-range advocates, what happens if a child is never allowed to fail?

your answer

5. True or False: most parents belong completely to one camp or the other.

True

False

6. What is the one goal both camps agree on?

your answer

GRAMMAR SPOTTING

Each quote below uses one of the five structures from "Quem Manda Aqui". Which case number (01 to 05) does it belong to?

*"They **make** their children wear helmets on tricycles."*

case number

*"They don't **let** a six-year-old walk to the corner store alone."*

case number

*"They **allow** eight-year-olds to walk home from school with a set of house keys."*

case number

*"Watching a child climb too high still **makes** most parents nervous."*

case number

*"A free-range parent might spend ten minutes **getting** a reluctant four-year-old to put on his own shoes."*

case number

"They let their toddler fall off the low step."

case number

DISCUSSION

No right answer. Use the target verbs if you can.

Would you let an 8-year-old walk to school alone in your neighborhood? Why or why not?

I would...

Would you rather raise a confident risk-taker or a cautious rule-follower? Can you have both?

I think...

Which line from the text do you agree with the most, and which do you disagree with?

I agree with...
